

Scenario

You are a level one security operations center (SOC) analyst at a financial services company. You have received an alert about a suspicious file being downloaded on an employee's computer.

You investigate this alert and discover that the employee received an email containing an attachment. The attachment was a password-protected spreadsheet file. The spreadsheet's password was provided in the email. The employee downloaded the file, then entered the password to open the file. When the employee opened the file, a malicious payload was then executed on their computer.

You retrieve the malicious file and create a SHA256 hash of the file.

Details of the alert

SHA256 file hash:

54e6ea47eb04634d3e87fd7787e2136ccfbcc80ade34f246a12cf93bab527f6b

A timeline of the events leading up to this alert:

- **1:11 p.m.:** An employee receives an email containing a file attachment.
- **1:13 p.m.:** The employee successfully downloads and opens the file.
- **1:15 p.m.:** Multiple unauthorized executable files are created on the employee's computer.
- **1:20 p.m.:** An intrusion detection system detects the executable files and sends out an alert to the SOC.